



NSW Education Standards Authority

2025 HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

Drama

**General
Instructions**

- Reading time – 5 minutes
- Working time – 1 hour and 30 minutes
- Write using black pen

**Total marks:
40****Section I – 20 marks** (page 2)

- Attempt Question 1
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section II – 20 marks (pages 3–6)

- Attempt ONE question from Questions 2–8
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section I — Australian Drama and Theatre (Core Study)

20 marks

Attempt Question 1

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 2–8 of the Drama Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate knowledge and understanding of drama and theatre relevant to the question
 - express your point of view using appropriate supporting evidence
 - present a sustained, logical and cohesive response
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Question 1 (20 marks)

How could Australian plays be staged to share diverse concerns with audiences?

In your response, refer to TWO plays you have studied and your own experiential learning.

Topic 1: Dramatic Traditions in Australia

Texts set for study:

- Alexander Buzo, *Norm and Ahmed*
- Wesley Enoch and Deborah Mailman, *The 7 Stages of Grieving*
- Robert Merritt, *The Cake Man*
- David Williamson, *The Removalists*

OR

Topic 2: Contemporary Australian Theatre Practice

Texts set for study:

- Yve Blake, *Fangirls*
- Jane Harrison, *The Visitors*
- Michelle Law, *Single Asian Female*
- Lally Katz, *Neighbourhood Watch*

Section II — Studies in Drama and Theatre

20 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 2–8

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question on pages 10–16 of the Drama Writing Booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate knowledge and understanding of drama and theatre relevant to the question
 - express your point of view using appropriate supporting evidence
 - present a sustained, logical and cohesive response
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Question 2 — The Voice of Women in Theatre (20 marks)

Compare how the TWO plays you have studied could be staged to voice socio/cultural judgements about women.

In your response, refer to the TWO plays you have studied and your own experiential learning.

Texts set for study:

List 1

- Caryl Churchill, *Top Girls*

or

- Aphra Behn, ‘The Rover’, in Trevor R Griffiths, Simon Trussler, William Wycherley, Aphra Behn and William Congreve, *Restoration Comedy*

AND

List 2

- Donna Abela, *Jump for Jordan*

or

- Mary Anne Butler, *Highway of Lost Hearts*

or

- Joanna Murray-Smith, *The Female of the Species*

or

- Leah Purcell and Scott Rankin, *Box the Pony*

OR

Question 3 — Approaches to Acting (20 marks)

How has your exploration of the expression of the actor's presence influenced your understanding of contemporary theatre practice?

In your response, refer to the TWO practitioners and texts you have studied and your own experiential learning.

Practitioners and texts set for study:

- Anne Bogart and Tina Landau, *The Viewpoints Book: A Practical Guide to Viewpoints and Composition*
- Jacques Lecoq, *The Moving Body (Le Corps Poétique): Teaching Creative Theatre* (David Bradby trans.)
- Jonathan Pitches, *Vsevolod Meyerhold*
- James Slowiak and Jairo Cuesta, *Jerzy Grotowski*

OR

Question 4 — Verbatim Theatre (20 marks)

How has your exploration of real issues or events in the plays you have studied influenced your understanding of the function of Verbatim Theatre?

In your response, refer to TWO plays you have studied and the development of a piece of original Verbatim Theatre.

Texts set for study:

- Campion Decent, *Embers*
- Robin Soans, *Talking to Terrorists*
- Alana Valentine, *Parramatta Girls*
- Tom Wright, *Black Diggers*

OR

Question 5 — Black Comedy (20 marks)

How has your exploration of the use of humour in plays from different countries influenced your understanding of the controversial in Black Comedy?

In your response, refer to the TWO plays you have studied and your own experiential learning.

Texts set for study:

- Neil LaBute, *The Shape of Things*
- Nakkiah Lui, *Black is the New White*
- Martin McDonagh, *The Lieutenant of Inishmore*
- Harold Pinter, *The Homecoming*

OR

Question 6 — Multi-Discipline Theatre (20 marks)

How has your exploration of creative processes that are focused on improvisation influenced your understanding of the function of Multi-Discipline Theatre?

In your response, refer to ONE practitioner in this topic and the development of an original piece of Multi-Discipline Theatre.

Practitioners and texts set for study:

- Robert Lepage and ExMachina

Texts set for study:

- Patrick Caux and Bernard Gilbert, *Ex Machina: Creating for the Stage* (Neil Kroetsch trans.)
- Aleksandar Saša Dundjerović, *Robert Lepage*

or

- Simon McBurney and Théâtre de Complicité

Texts set for study:

- Complicité and Simon McBurney, *A Disappearing Number*
- Sarah Ainslie, *Complicité: Rehearsal Notes*

OR

Question 7 — Significant Plays of the 20th Century (20 marks)

How has your exploration of the reinvention of theatrical styles influenced your understanding of the impact of significant plays?

In your response, refer to the TWO plays you have studied and your own experiential learning.

Texts set for study:

- Bertolt Brecht and David Hare, *Mother Courage and Her Children*
- Eugène Ionesco, *The Bald Prima Donna: A Pseudo-Play in One Act* (Donald Watson trans.)
- Moisés Kaufman, *The Laramie Project*
- Lorraine Hansberry, *A Raisin in the Sun*

OR

Question 8 — Japanese Traditional and Contemporary Theatre (20 marks)

How has your exploration of both traditional and contemporary forms influenced your understanding of the purpose of Japanese theatre?

In your response, refer to your study of ONE traditional form, ONE contemporary work and your own experiential learning of this topic.

Texts set for study:

ONE of the following traditional Japanese forms:

- James R Brandon, *Kabuki: Five Classic Plays* (J R Brandon trans.)
- Ernest Francisco Fenollosa and Ezra Pound, *The Noh Theatre of Japan: With Complete Texts of 15 Classic Plays*
- Stanleigh H Jones, *The Bunraku Puppet Theatre of Japan: Honor, Vengeance, and Love in Four Plays of the 18th and 19th Centuries* (S H Jones trans.)

AND ONE of the following contemporary works of Tadashi Suzuki:

- Tadashi Suzuki, *The Way of Acting: The Theatre Writings of Tadashi Suzuki* (T Suzuki trans.)

or

- Paul Allain, *The Art of Stillness: The Theatre Practice of Tadashi Suzuki*

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